

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 130 OF 153

# Shogun Chess

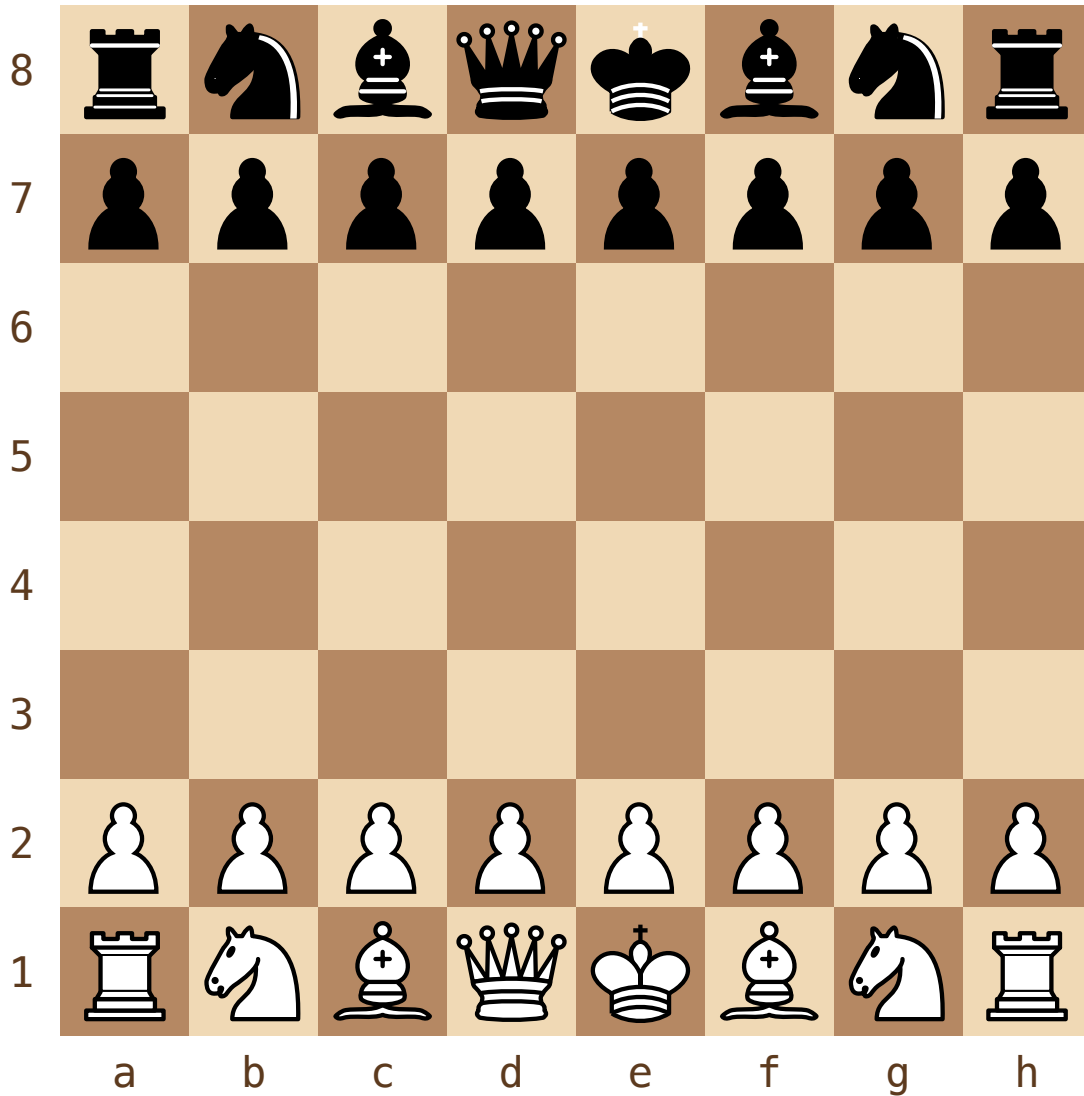
**8×8**

BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

## SHOGUN CHESS



*Shogun Chess – starting position*

<https://engine.moddable.games/play/?game=moddable-chess&variant=shogun>

Designed by Corey Clark (2020). Shogun Chess grafts the drop mechanic from Shogi onto a standard chess board: captured pieces switch sides and can be returned to play, and pieces automatically promote when they enter the opponent's half of the board.

## PROMOTION ZONE

Ranks 6, 7, and 8 (for White) — the opponent's half of the board — form the promotion zone. Any piece that enters a promotion-zone square, or that starts a turn already in the zone, promotes immediately and automatically. Captured promoted pieces revert to their base form.

Black's promotion zone is ranks 3, 2, and 1.

## PIECE PROMOTIONS

| BASE PIECE | PROMOTED NAME        | PROMOTED MOVEMENT                                                                          |
|------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pawn       | Pawn+ (Gold General) | One step in any orthogonal direction, or one step diagonally forward (6 directions total). |
| Knight     | Monk                 | All 8 standard Knight jumps, plus one step orthogonally in any direction.                  |
| Bishop     | Ninja                | Bishop diagonal slides (unlimited), plus one step orthogonally in any direction.           |
| Rook       | Fortress             | Rook orthogonal slides (unlimited), plus one step diagonally in any direction.             |
| Queen      | Shogun               | Queen moves (any direction, unlimited) plus one Knight jump per move.                      |
| King       | Does not promote     | —                                                                                          |

## DROP MECHANIC

When a player captures an opponent's piece, that piece is added to the capturing player's hand in its base (unpromoted) form. On any turn, instead of moving a piece already on the board, the player may drop one piece from their hand onto any empty square, subject to the restrictions below.

### Drop restrictions:

- Drops may not be made into the promotion zone (ranks 6–8 for White; ranks 1–3 for Black).
- A dropped Pawn cannot be placed on a file already containing a friendly Pawn.
- A Pawn may not be dropped to deliver immediate checkmate. (A Pawn drop that gives check without checkmate is legal.)
- Drops do not trigger promotion — a piece dropped in a legal zone square enters as its base form and only promotes when it subsequently moves into the promotion zone.

## STARTING POSITION

Standard FIDE starting position. Both hands begin empty.

|   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8 |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 7 |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 6 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 |
| 5 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 |
| 4 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 |
| 3 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 | .                                                                                 |
| 2 |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| 1 |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|   | a                                                                                 | b                                                                                 | c                                                                                 | d                                                                                 | e                                                                                 | f                                                                                 | g                                                                                 | h                                                                                 |

## STANDARD RULES

Castling applies under standard FIDE conditions (neither King nor Rook has previously moved; squares between them are empty; King does not pass through check). En passant applies. Pawn promotion on reaching rank 8 follows standard rules – the player chooses Queen, Rook, Bishop, or Knight in their Shogun promoted forms.

## CHECK AND CHECKMATE

Standard rules. A player in check must resolve it immediately. Dropping a piece to interpose between the attacking piece and the King is legal. Checkmate ends the game; the checkmated player loses.

## STALEMATE

Standard: stalemate is a draw.

## ATTRIBUTION

Designed by Corey Clark. Published via Shogun of Games. Official rules at [shogunofgames.com](http://shogunofgames.com).